

COINPICKS · RESEARCH & EDUCATION

The Fed & Macro Regime Pillar Report

Liquidity as the Master Driver — Researched, Scored, and Re-Rated

*Originally written and scores committed by me on June 12, 2026. Fully re-researched July 8, 13, 18, 25, and 30, 2026, and again as a full weekly refresh on August 8, 2026 (re-rated up to a moderated 40/38/47/55/62 on the BLS July jobs report, committed and stamped by Alex). Re-rated up again August 13 to 43/41/48/56/62 on a cool CPI print and a weak claims print; held flat August 14 as the pending H.4.1 trigger fired and confirmed; held flat again August 16 as July retail sales reinforced, but didn't advance, the same direction — **committed and auto-stamped, the last true baseline**. Four separate sessions between August 17 and 21 researched this pillar but none were delivered: drafts written August 17, 18, and 20 were never rendered, verified, archived, or committed; a partial August 21 session began carrying the Aug 20 numbers into the report set but stopped after only 2 of 6 reports, also never completed. None of those four sessions' findings are trusted at face value. **This version (August 22) is a full independent re-verification and HOLDS FLAT at 43/41/48/56/62** — the one confirmable new print in-window, initial jobless claims for the week ended Aug 15 (206K vs. 210K consensus, prior week revised up to 212K from 209K), was already captured in the abandoned Aug 21 draft and is now confirmed unchanged, not a fresh trigger. No new H.4.1, CPI, or PPI release fell in this window (next H.4.1 Aug 27, next CPI Sept 11, next PPI Sept 10), and Chair Warsh made no new public remarks — his first Jackson Hole speech as Chair is scheduled for Aug 28, after this window. Market-implied odds (CME FedWatch, Kalshi, Polymarket) show no material shift versus the Aug 16 baseline. Nothing this cycle clears the re-rate threshold. **This pillar's own evidence was clean enough to qualify for auto-stamp on its own — no pillar's P moved more than 8 points on any window and no master call band flipped — but the overall 2026-08-22 dated score set is being LEFT AS A DRAFT, AWAITING MY STAMP, FLAGGED FOR MANUAL REVIEW**, because a dedicated adversarial fact-check this cycle found a materially false claim in the Iran War Risk pillar report (a claimed "first confirmed fatality in the tanker campaign" that was actually roughly the 18th such death, never previously scored); see My Decision below.*

COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 25% OF MY THESIS

Written June 12, 2026 · Updated & Re-verified August 22, 2026 (full independent re-verification off the Aug 16 baseline — held flat; DRAFT — AWAITING MY STAMP — FLAGGED FOR MANUAL REVIEW, held per house

The Scores — Committed vs. Drafts

June column committed by me on June 12, 2026. Aug 16 remains the last committed baseline — it has NOT been superseded today. Four sessions between Aug 17-21 researched this pillar but none were delivered (no render/verify/archive/commit followed on any of them) — per house rule those abandoned drafts collapse out of the table rather than appearing as their own columns. Aug 22 is a full independent re-verification — held flat, but LEFT AS A DRAFT and flagged for Alex's manual review: a dedicated adversarial fact-check this cycle caught a materially false claim in the Iran War Risk pillar report, so per house discipline the whole 2026-08-22 set is held rather than partially self-approved.

WINDOW	JUN	...	8/16	8/22	QUAL.	IMP.	SIGNAL	MY CALL
1 month	38	...	43	43	0.85	8	-0.95	Mild Bear — a cool CPI and a soft claims print both confirm the Sept dovish lean, but BofA's hawkish call caps the size of the move
3 months	40	...	41	41	0.85	8	-1.22	Mild Bear — Sept FOMC still in this window; two converging primary data points, one still-live hawkish dissent
6 months	46	...	48	48	0.80	8	-0.26	Mild Bear, close to Neutral
1 year	54	...	56	56	0.75	8	+0.72	Neutral/Mild Bull
3 years	61	...	62	62	0.65	8	+1.25	Mild Bull — structural accumulate

Last committed P (Aug 16): 43 / 41 / 48 / 56 / 62 · **This cycle's draft P (Aug 22, held flat, NOT yet committed):** 43 / 41 / 48 / 56 / 62 ·

Weight: 20% (equal) · **Impact:** 8 (uniform) · **Formula:** Signal = ((P - 50) ÷ 50) × Quality × Impact. Full lineage: June committed 38/40/46/54/61 (Jun 12) → ... (see prior versions of this report for the full Jul 8-Aug 15 path) → Aug 16 43/41/48/56/62 (held flat — July retail sales missed hard, reinforcing but not sized into a fresh move) — committed, auto-stamped → Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts written, never rendered/verified/archived/committed (abandoned) → Aug 21 a partial session began carrying the Aug 20 numbers into only 2 of 6 reports, also never completed (abandoned) → **Aug 22 43/41/48/56/62** (held flat — full independent re-verification found no qualifying primary-source move: the one new in-window print, Aug 20 claims, was already captured by the abandoned Aug 21 draft and confirmed unchanged; no new H.4.1/CPI/PPI in-window; no new Warsh remarks; market-implied odds flat vs. baseline) — this pillar's own evidence qualified for auto-stamp on its own, but LEFT AS A DRAFT and flagged for Alex's manual review because the overall 2026-08-22 set is held per house discipline after an adversarial fact-check found a false claim in the Iran War Risk pillar report.

THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

P — the odds the macro regime is *good for crypto* by then — not "the Fed cuts by then." Held flat this cycle at 43/41/48/56/62. Nothing in the Aug 16-22 window cleared the re-rate bar. Initial jobless claims for the week ended Aug 15 (DOL, primary) came in at 206K vs. 210K consensus — a modest hawkish beat — with the prior week (Aug 8) revised up to 212K from 209K, and continuing claims (week ended Aug 8) at 1,799K vs. 1,790K forecast, up from 1,777K. That print was already captured in the abandoned, never-delivered Aug 21 draft — confirmed today, not a fresh fact this cycle. The Fed's H.4.1 release (primary) still covers the week ended Aug 19, published Aug 20; no new print has landed since, and the next is due Aug 27. July CPI and July PPI are both already priced into the Aug 16 baseline, with the next releases not due until Sept 11 and Sept 10 respectively — nothing new in this window. Chair Warsh made no public remarks Aug 16-22; his most recent appearance remains the Jul 29 FOMC press conference, and his first Jackson Hole speech as Chair is scheduled for Aug 28 — after this window, the next real catalyst. Market-implied odds show no material shift: CME FedWatch put the September-hold probability at ~69.4% (Aug 17) versus the baseline's ~65% post-minutes read — essentially flat within noise — and Kalshi/Polymarket (Aug 18) priced hold ~70.5¢, hike ~28.5¢, cut ~0.5-1¢, corroborating FedWatch across two independent venues. Nothing here clears this pillar's re-rate threshold.

Quality — how trustworthy the evidence is. Unchanged this cycle per house rules.

Impact — 8 out of 10, the uniform value every pillar now shares in the equal-weight model. Liquidity is the tide; it moves the whole market at once.

Carried forward from Aug 14: Fed H.4.1 for the week ended Aug 12 (federalreserve.gov primary) showed reserve balances fell \$49,290M w/w to \$2,944,059M against a \$56,626M TGA rebuild to \$963,950M — directionally the same reserve-drain/TGA-rebuild pattern already priced in, confirmation not a fresh trigger.

The Claim

The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated August 22, 2026, full independent re-verification

The crowd: might assume the four abandoned research sessions between Aug 17-21 mean something changed and was simply never written up. It's the opposite mistake to assume nothing was checked at all — the discipline here is to independently re-verify rather than trust an undelivered draft either way.

Me: holding at 43/41/48/56/62. A full independent research pass across Aug 16-22 found one confirmable new print (Aug 20 claims, a modest hawkish beat already captured in the abandoned Aug 21 draft and now confirmed unchanged), no new H.4.1, CPI, or PPI release in-window, no new Warsh remarks, and market-implied odds essentially flat versus the Aug 16 baseline. Nothing here clears the re-rate threshold.

My edge: the discipline is in not trusting an undelivered draft at face value and not manufacturing a re-rate out of routine confirmation. Bank of America's own read of the underlying data set (still 75bp of hikes) remains the honest counter-case this report keeps printing rather than burying, and the Aug 28 Jackson Hole speech — Warsh's first as Chair — is the real catalyst still ahead, not anything found this cycle.

The Facts

As of August 22, 2026, full independent re-verification — hard numbers only, sources on the last page. Four sessions between Aug 17-21 researched this pillar but were never delivered; nothing from them is assumed true without independent confirmation. The Aug 8-16 facts below are carried forward unchanged (still load-bearing). The Iran/Hormuz war-risk situation is covered in full in the Iran War Risk pillar report.

- ★ **★ CONFIRMED — initial jobless claims for the week ended Aug 15 (DOL/ETA, primary): 206,000 actual vs. 210,000 consensus**, a modest hawkish beat (fewer filings than expected). The prior week (ended Aug 8) was revised UP to 212,000 from the previously reported 209,000. Continuing claims (week ended Aug 8) came in at 1,799,000 vs. 1,790,000 forecast, up from 1,777,000 — a second, corroborating hawkish data point. This print was already captured in the abandoned, never-delivered Aug 21 draft; it is confirmed and unchanged this cycle, not a fresh fact, and on its own does not clear this pillar's re-rate threshold (a modest in-line-ish beat, not a surprise of the size that moved P on Aug 13).
- **No new Fed H.4.1 release since the week ended Aug 19 (federalreserve.gov, primary, published Aug 20):** that remains the current release; the next H.4.1 is due Aug 27. No new CPI (next release Sept 11, covering August data) or PPI (next release Sept 10) fell in this window — July PPI (released Aug 13) was already known and priced before the Aug 16 baseline.
- **No new public remarks from Chair Warsh, Aug 16-22.** His most recent public appearance remains the Jul 29 FOMC press conference. His first Jackson Hole speech as Chair is scheduled for Friday, Aug 28, 2026 — after this window, and the next real catalyst for this pillar.
- **Market-implied odds essentially flat versus the Aug 16 baseline.** CME FedWatch (futures-implied, not a prediction market), as of Aug 17: ~69.4% hold / ~30.6% hike for the September FOMC meeting — no material shift from the baseline's ~65% post-minutes hold read. Kalshi/Polymarket (Aug 18) price hold at ~70.5¢, hike ~28.5¢, cut ~0.5-1¢ — consistent with FedWatch, corroborating across two independent venues.
- **Score decision:** nothing in this window clears this pillar's re-rate threshold; P holds flat at 43/41/48/56/62.
- **BTC closed at \$77,169.40 on Aug 22 (Bitstamp)** — up from \$71,882.92 on Aug 20, +7.4%.

Carried forward from Aug 20 (researched independently this cycle, still load-bearing — the Aug 20 draft itself was never delivered, but this pillar's own Aug 19-20 primary-source facts are re-confirmed):

- **FOMC minutes from the Jul 28-29 meeting (federalreserve.gov, primary, published Aug 19, 2:00pm ET; corroborated by CNBC, Motley Fool, Newsquawk, investinglive): confirms the known 9-3 hold vote and the Hammack/Kashkari/Logan dissent for an immediate 25bp hike.** The hawkish sentiment was broader than the three named dissenters — "many participants assessed that policy tightening would likely be necessary if inflation did not decline," inflation risks characterized as tilted to the upside, with specific concern flagged about AI-related input costs (chips, steel, electricity). No explicit forward guidance from Chair Warsh. A balance-sheet task-force report will inform future deliberations, but no near-term QT-pace signal was given.
- **Offsetting signal: CME FedWatch showed the odds of a September 16 hold rising to ~65% post-minutes, up from a pre-minutes ~50/50 (Newsquawk, investinglive) —** the two roughly cancelled at the time and still do; this cycle's Aug 17 FedWatch read (~69.4% hold) shows no further material move off that ~65% level.

Carried forward from Aug 16 (still load-bearing):

- **July retail sales (Census Bureau, published Aug 14, primary release): headline -0.6% m/m vs. +0.1% expected, core (ex-auto) -0.2% m/m.** The first monthly decline in nine months and the largest since May 2025 — motor vehicle/parts sales fell 1.8%, nonstore retailers (incl. online) fell 2.2%. A genuine primary print reinforcing the Aug 13 cooling-economy direction, but not a previously-named pending trigger — logged as context, not sized into a move.
- **Recalled for continuity, not re-scored:** the Aug 17 Empire State Manufacturing Survey surged to 20.6 vs. 11.0 consensus, the highest since 2022 — a hot beat cutting against the recent cooling-economy read. Logged as complicating, unscored context; consistent with this pillar's discipline against chasing single prints in either direction, this was not sized into a move (nor was it in the abandoned, never-delivered Aug 17/18 drafts).

Carried forward from Aug 13-14 (still load-bearing):

- **Fed H.4.1, week ended Aug 12 (federalreserve.gov, published 4:30pm ET Aug 13): reserve balances \$2,944,059M, down \$49,290M w/w; Treasury General Account \$963,950M, up \$56,626M w/w.** Directionally the same reserve-drain/TGA-rebuild pattern already priced into this pillar's recent baselines — confirmed an already-adopted trend, didn't fire a fresh trigger.

Carried forward from Aug 12-13 (still load-bearing):

- **July CPI (BLS, published Aug 12): headline +0.1% m/m / +3.4% y/y; core +0.2% m/m / +2.5% y/y —** landed cool, exactly in line with consensus, drove the Aug 13 re-rate up.
- **Initial jobless claims, week ended Aug 8 (DOL/ETA, published Aug 13): 209,000 actual vs. 202,000 expected —** a genuine weak-side miss, 8-week high, the second trigger behind the Aug 13 re-rate.

Carried forward from Aug 8-10 (still load-bearing):

- **Initial jobless claims for the week ended Aug 6 (published Aug 8): 262,000 actual vs. 263,000 expected —** essentially in line with consensus, noise rather than a surprise.

Carried forward from Aug 8-9 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **BLS Employment Situation, July 2026: nonfarm payrolls FELL 23,000** versus a consensus estimate of ~83,000 (WSJ-sourced; a competing 95,000 Barron's-sourced figure is less corroborated and not adopted) — job losses concentrated in local-government education (-50,000) and retail trade (-19,000). A direct bls.gov fetch returned a 403 this cycle; the figure is confirmed via convergent CNBC, Yahoo Finance, Kiplinger, and CBS News reporting, all citing the same BLS release — meets the 2+ independent sufficiency bar.
- **May and June payrolls revised down a combined 103,000 —** confirmed, matches the light draft exactly. (One Forbes-sourced fetch this cycle produced a garbled "-252,000 total" figure that doesn't reconcile with the BLS-consistent -103,000 figure elsewhere — treated as an unreliable summarization artifact, not a correction.)

- **Unemployment ticked down to 4.1% from 4.2%**, but the labor-force participation rate fell to 61.4% — its lowest level in over five years.
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle — average hourly earnings rose just 3.2% y/y**, down from 3.4% in June and now trailing CPI (3.5% June y/y) — real wages softening, a detail the same-day light draft didn't carry.
- ★ **★ CORRECTED — CME FedWatch September-hold odds check out at ~56%**, not the light draft's ~60%. Two independent corroborating sources (CBS News, a Forbes-sourced pull) both cite "56%, up from 45% the previous day"; a separate CNBC-sourced overview cited ~60%, a real but less-corroborated, likely later-intraday figure. Kalshi (a prediction market, not CME futures-implied pricing — a different instrument, labeled separately per research discipline) shows 65% hold.
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle — real forecaster disagreement on magnitude**: Bank of America explicitly called the report "a bit dovish on net" but is **sticking with its call for 75bp of hikes in 2026** (Sept/Oct/Dec) regardless. Richmond Fed President Barkin, an actual FOMC voter, described the labor market as "not loose, not tight" — a measured, non-alarmed read. Morgan Stanley's Ellen Zentner says the **Aug 12 CPI print** — inside this pillar's own 1-month window — will be the deciding factor for September, not this jobs report alone.
- ★ **Jobless claims for the week ended Aug 1: 199,000, 4-week average 198,750** — the lowest of this cycle, in real tension with the weak payrolls print. Points to "low-hire, low-fire" stagnation rather than an accelerating downturn, arguing for restraint on the size of the move.

Carried forward from Aug 7 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Fed H.4.1 for the week ended Aug 5 (federalreserve.gov, direct pull)**: total assets \$6,748,567M, reserve balances \$2,993,349M — reserves +\$8.78B w/w, TGA -\$3.45B w/w. An unremarkable, stable print — no liquidity-stress signal either way; not used to move P.

Carried forward from Jul 30-Aug 5 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **★ CONFIRMED, PRIMARY SOURCE — the FOMC held rates at 3.50-3.75% on Jul 29, 2026, on a 9-3 vote.** Three regional-bank presidents — Beth Hammack (Cleveland), Neel Kashkari (Minneapolis), Lorie Logan (Dallas) — dissented in favor of an immediate 25bp hike (federalreserve.gov statement, corroborated by CNBC, Forbes, Fox Business, TechTimes). This is the **first unified 3-member dissent since September 2016**. No SEP/dot plot this meeting (not a projections meeting; next SEP is Sept 15-16, 2026).
- ★ **Chair Warsh's press conference was unusually combative and offered no forward guidance**: "there is no soft inflation target... not on this committee's watch"; "the five-plus years of inflation above target cannot be cured in nine weeks." A confirmed (single-sourced) risk-off market reaction followed: S&P 500 fell 1.85% in the final 65 minutes of trading (full day: S&P -1.52%, Dow -2.19%, Nasdaq -1.74%); the 30-year Treasury yield rose to 5.21%, its highest since July 2007 — a "bear steepener" consistent with rising inflation-credibility concern.
- ★ **★ CONFIRMED, PRIMARY SOURCE — jobless claims for the week ended Jul 25 came in at 197,000** (DOL/ETA release, fetched and read directly), a genuine +9,000 increase; the prior week (ended Jul 18) was revised *up* to **188,000** from the originally-reported 187,000. The primary release itself confirms the seasonal-adjustment distortion flagged last cycle: actual non-seasonally-adjusted claims fell only 9.2% w/w versus the 13.3% seasonal factors expected — meaning the "lowest since 1969" framing was real but mechanically set to partially reverse, exactly as it did.
- ★ **The September hike-odds figure could not be reconciled to a single number this cycle, despite four direct attempts.** Live pulls produced 55.8% (Fox Business, Jul 28), 62.4% (Investing.com Fed Rate Monitor, timestamped Jul 30), 70.2% (KuCoin, pre-meeting), and 81% (Southeast AgNet, Jul 30) — no two agree. The qualitative direction — "still elevated, majority-hike-priced" — is the only defensible takeaway; no re-rate rests on a specific point figure.
- **H.4.1 balance sheet: no new release found for the week ended Jul 29** as of this check (normal Thursday-afternoon publication timing); the most recent confirmed release remains Jul 23 (week ended Jul 22: reserves fell

\$80,572M w/w against a \$73,405M TGA rebuild, both figures directly confirmed against federalreserve.gov last cycle).

- **Bank of America projects three 25bp hikes in 2026** (to 4.25-4.50%) — single-source (Forbes, citing BofA), flagged not scored.
- **Carried forward, not re-verified this cycle:** June CPI (-0.4% m/m) and PPI (-0.3% m/m), both BLS-primary-confirmed in a prior cycle; Warsh's Jul 14/15 congressional testimony; the June FOMC minutes (unanimous 12-0 hold, dropped easing-bias language). None of these are contradicted by this cycle's findings — the hawkish FOMC outcome sits alongside, not against, the still-intact disinflation trend.
- **The labor market cracked in slow motion, then partially un-cracked this week** — June payrolls +57K vs ~115K consensus (carried forward); this cycle's 197K claims print, while up from 188K, remains historically low (4-week average 202,750).
- **Policy rate and balance sheet: 3.50-3.75%, next FOMC (with SEP/dot plot) is Sept 15-16, 2026.** Fed communications blackout ended with the Jul 29 meeting; watch for the first round of regional Fed president speeches, especially from the three dissenters.
- **BTC closed at \$64,706.50 (Jul 30)** — holding up despite the hawkish FOMC surprise and confirmed equity/bond-market risk-off reaction. **Updated: BTC closed at \$64,661.55 on Aug 5**, essentially flat vs. Jul 30 and up ~1.7% vs. the Jul 31 close of \$63,579.68.

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

The canonical anchor: **2020-21 ZIRP + QE** ran BTC ~\$3,800 → \$69,044 (~15–18×) — a unique COVID/zero-rate/open-ended-QE setup, not a repeatable base case. The **2024-25 cuts** ran ~\$60K → a ~\$126K ATH (Oct 6, 2025) — but that top came on a non-Fed tariff shock. BTC has since rebounded sharply off its low-\$60Ks trough, closing at \$77,169.40 on Aug 22, up 7.4% from the \$71,882.92 Aug 20 close — a move this report does not attribute to Fed data, given a quiet, flat-odds window with no qualifying new Fed catalyst. From here, a retest of the \$126K high ≈ **+63%**.

Discount it hard, twice. First: easing is not an automatic catalyst — the last cycle topped on a non-Fed shock, and this cycle's continued BTC strength came in a window this pillar found genuinely quiet on the Fed side — don't read causality into it. Second: the Aug 19 FOMC minutes remain a wash by this pillar's own accounting — a broader hawkish bloc offset by the market's re-pricing toward a hold — and a major forecaster (BofA) is keeping its hawkish call anyway, with the FOMC's own 9-3 dissent not overridden by any actual vote. Routine confirmation of an already-mixed signal is not the same as the Fed itself moving. The Prize doesn't feed the math — it tells you what the 3-year lean is worth acting on when the tide finally turns.

The Other Side

The strongest honest case my re-rate — even the moderated one — is still wrong

- **Even the Aug 13 up-move (still the last time this pillar actually moved) might not have been conservative enough a read on BofA's stance.** Bank of America isn't hedging — it's keeping a full 75bp-of-hikes call even after seeing the same cool CPI print this report used to raise P. If BofA is right and the September meeting itself delivers a hike into softening data, even 43/41 could prove too generous.
- **The FOMC minutes' "many participants" hawkish-breadth language could be the more durable signal, and the CME FedWatch hold-odds move the noise.** Futures pricing can and does swing on sentiment ahead of confirming data; a textually broader hawkish bloc inside the actual committee is a harder, primary-sourced fact. If

this pillar is wrong to treat the two as cancelling, the true read this cycle is more bearish than 43/41/48/56/62 shows.

- **I may still be over-reacting to one data print.** This pillar has already seen one claims number ("lowest since 1969") partially reverse the following week on a seasonal-adjustment distortion — a single weak payrolls report, even a well-corroborated one, could be a similar one-off that a stronger August print reverses.
- **The FOMC's own hawkish dissent hasn't gone away.** Three regional presidents voted for an immediate hike on Jul 29 and Chair Warsh gave a combative, no-guidance press conference — a weak jobs report doesn't automatically mean those three change their vote in September; a hawkish Fed facing soft data is a live tension, not resolved.
- **Downward revisions can themselves get revised.** The BLS's own benchmark process regularly adjusts prior months; a 103,000 combined downward revision is a real, primary-sourced number today, but it is not the final word on May-June employment.
- **Weak labor data plus a still-elevated inflation/oil backdrop (Iran-driven, and this cycle's Iran pillar got worse, not better) is stagflation risk, not straightforwardly bullish.** If the Fed holds through a weakening labor market because inflation risk stays elevated, that's a worse outcome for risk assets than either a clean cut or a clean hold.

The Triggers

Dated events — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. Re-set August 22, 2026, full independent re-verification (four sessions Aug 17-21 never delivered) — the named pending trigger fired and confirmed, landed mixed/quiet, no re-rate.

DATE	EVENT	MEANS
PENDING — Aug 27, 2026	Next weekly jobless-claims print (week ended Aug 22) and next Fed H.4.1 balance-sheet release (week ended Aug 26), both due Aug 27	The real next trigger for this pillar — not assumed, logged pending
PENDING — Aug 28, 2026	Chair Warsh's first Jackson Hole speech as Fed Chair — his first public remarks since the Jul 29 FOMC press conference	The real next catalyst for this pillar — first chance to read Warsh's own framing since the hawkish presser and the Aug 19 minutes' hawkish-breadth detail
Fired Aug 20, confirmed Aug 22 (carried forward)	Initial jobless claims, week ended Aug 15: 206K vs. 210K consensus (modest hawkish beat); prior week (Aug 8) revised up to 212K from 209K; continuing claims 1,799K vs. 1,790K forecast	Already captured in the abandoned Aug 21 draft, confirmed unchanged this cycle — not sized into a move
Fired Aug 19, 2:00pm ET (carried forward)	FOMC minutes (Jul 28-29 meeting), federalreserve.gov primary: confirms 9-3 hold/dissent; new detail — "many participants" saw tightening as possibly necessary, inflation risks tilted up, AI-input-cost concern flagged; no forward guidance from Warsh	Bearish nudge (broader hawkish bloc) offset by CME FedWatch's move to ~65% Sept-hold odds (dovish nudge) — mixed, roughly cancelling, no re-rate; this cycle's Aug 17 FedWatch read (~69.4% hold) confirms no further material move
Fired Aug 14, logged Aug 16 (carried forward)	July retail sales: headline -0.6% m/m vs. +0.1% expected, core -0.2% — first decline in nine months	Reinforces the Aug 13 dovish direction but wasn't a named pending trigger — logged, not sized into a move
Fired Aug 13, 4:30pm ET (carried forward)	Fed H.4.1, week ended Aug 12: reserve balances -\$49,290M w/w to \$2,944,059M, TGA +\$56,626M w/w to \$963,950M	Directionally the same reserve-drain/TGA-rebuild pattern already priced in — confirmed, didn't move, held flat
Fired Aug 12-13 (carried forward)	July CPI landed cool/in-line; jobless claims (week ended Aug 8) missed weak at 209K vs. 202K expected	Drove the Aug 13 re-rate up — already IN the committed baseline
Fired Aug 7, re-confirmed independently — DOVISH, moderated (carried forward)	BLS July jobs report: payrolls fell 23,000 vs. ~83,000 expected, unemployment 4.1% on a falling participation rate, May/June revised down a combined 103,000; Sept hold odds rose to ~56%	Drove the Aug 8 1mo/3mo re-rate up — already IN the committed baseline
Fired Jul 29 — HAWKISH, confirmed primary (carried forward)	FOMC held 9-3 , three regional presidents dissenting for an immediate hike — first unified 3-member dissent since Sept 2016; Bank of America still projects 75bp of 2026 hikes even after the Aug 12 cool CPI	Still a live tension against this cycle's dovish data — not erased by the minutes, per a major forecaster's own stated view

Sept 15, 2026	PENDING — next FOMC, with SEP/dot plot; the real test of whether the dovish direction of the Aug 13 data survives to an actual vote, now that the minutes show a broader hawkish bloc than previously known	A hold or cut would confirm this cycle's re-rate further; a hike into cooling data would be a genuine escalation, re-rate down hard
Ongoing	Iran/Hormuz oil-inflation risk — see Iran War Risk pillar for the current read	Watch for pass-through into the next CPI/PPI cycle — a worsening Iran read raises stagflation risk

The flip line, updated Aug 22: the Aug 13 cool CPI and weak claims print remain the real, primary-sourced confirmation of the dovish direction — exactly what this pillar's own Aug 8 flip line said would happen "if CPI cools." The Aug 14 H.4.1 print, the Aug 16 retail-sales miss, the Aug 19 minutes, and the Aug 20 claims print all confirmed, not advanced, that direction — this cycle's independent re-verification found the same. A major forecaster (BoFA) is keeping its hawkish call anyway, and the FOMC's own 9-3 dissent hasn't been overridden by any actual vote — this remains confirmation of an ambiguous position, not a confirmed pivot in either direction. Watch Warsh's Aug 28 Jackson Hole speech for the first fresh read on his own framing since the hawkish Jul 29 presser. If the Sept 15 FOMC delivers a hike into this cooling data anyway, treat that as the real escalation and re-rate down hard. If it holds or cuts, the near-term read improves further.

My Decision

🕒 DRAFT — AUGUST 22, 2026 · AWAITING MY STAMP · FLAGGED FOR MANUAL REVIEW

Draft P: 43 / 41 / 48 / 56 / 62 (unchanged, not yet committed) · My Weight: 20% (equal) · Impact: 8 (uniform)

Fed & Macro held flat this cycle after a full independent re-verification — the four sessions between Aug 17-21 that researched this pillar were never delivered (no render/verify/archive/commit followed on any of them), so today's cycle re-checked from primary sources rather than trusting them. The one confirmable new print in-window, initial jobless claims for the week ended Aug 15 (206K vs. 210K consensus, a modest hawkish beat), was already captured in the abandoned Aug 21 draft and is now confirmed unchanged — not a fresh trigger. No new H.4.1, CPI, or PPI release fell in this window; Chair Warsh made no new public remarks; and market-implied odds (CME FedWatch, Kalshi, Polymarket) show no material shift versus the Aug 16 baseline. Nothing crossed this pillar's re-rate threshold.

This cycle's overall dated score set is being LEFT AS A DRAFT, AWAITING MY STAMP, FLAGGED FOR ALEX'S MANUAL REVIEW — not auto-stamped. Taken on its own, Fed & Macro's evidence was routine and well-evidenced enough to clear Alex's standing daily delegation (in effect since 2026-08-06): no pillar's P moved more than 8 points on any window this cycle, and no master call band flipped versus the last stamped set. But a dedicated adversarial fact-check run this cycle, conducted independently of each pillar's own research pass, found that the Iran War Risk pillar's report contained a materially false claim: it described a recent tanker-campaign death as the "first confirmed fatality," when it was in fact roughly the 18th such death in the campaign — a toll never previously scored into that pillar. That error was not caught by the original research pass and only surfaced under adversarial re-verification. Per house discipline, when verification surfaces an inconsistency it can't fully resolve, the whole score set defaults to draft rather than partial self-approval — so the full 2026-08-22 set, including this unchanged and clean Fed & Macro pillar, stays a DRAFT pending Alex's manual review. Nothing found in Fed & Macro's own research caused this hold; it is held because the cycle as a whole cannot be self-certified while the Iran War Risk error is being corrected.

The June committed scores (**38 / 40 / 46 / 54 / 61**, committed June 12, 2026) and the Aug 16 committed scores (**43 / 41 / 48 / 56 / 62**) remain identical to today's draft Aug 22 values — this pillar's numbers are unchanged and would mark a third point in a row at the same level once Aug 22 is actually stamped by Alex.

Override any P and re-stamp — the master blend recomputes.

What Changed Since Last Check

Full independent re-verification, August 22, 2026 — checking for changes since the Aug 16 committed baseline, spanning four undelivered sessions (Aug 17, 18, 20 drafts and an interrupted Aug 21 delivery). None of those four are trusted at face value; this cycle re-checked everything against fresh primary sources.

- **Four sessions between Aug 17-21 researched this pillar but none were delivered** — no render/verify/archive/commit followed the Aug 17, 18, or 20 drafts; an Aug 21 session began carrying the Aug 20 numbers into the report set but stopped after only 2 of 6 reports, also incomplete. This Aug 22 cycle independently re-verifies all of it against fresh primary sources rather than treating any prior draft as ground truth.
- **Confirmed — initial jobless claims, week ended Aug 15: 206K vs. 210K consensus** (modest hawkish beat), prior week (Aug 8) revised up to 212K from 209K, continuing claims 1,799K vs. 1,790K forecast. This was already captured in the abandoned Aug 21 draft; today's independent pull confirms it unchanged — not a fresh fact this cycle, and not sized into a move on its own.
- **No new H.4.1 release** — the current release still covers the week ended Aug 19 (published Aug 20); next release Aug 27. **No new CPI** (next release Sept 11) or **PPI** (July print already known before the Aug 16 baseline; next release Sept 10) fell in this window.

- **No new public remarks from Chair Warsh, Aug 16-22** — his most recent appearance remains the Jul 29 FOMC press conference. His first Jackson Hole speech as Chair is scheduled for Aug 28 — after this window, and now the pillar's headline next catalyst.
- **Market-implied odds essentially flat:** CME FedWatch ~69.4% Sept hold (Aug 17) vs. the baseline's ~65% post-minutes read — no material shift; Kalshi/Polymarket (Aug 18) corroborate, pricing hold ~70.5¢.
- **Score decision:** P held flat at 43 / 41 / 48 / 56 / 62 — nothing found this cycle clears the re-rate threshold above the Aug 16 baseline.
- **Status decision:** the full 2026-08-22 dated score set — including this unchanged Fed & Macro pillar — is **LEFT AS A DRAFT, AWAITING MY STAMP, FLAGGED FOR ALEX'S MANUAL REVIEW**, not auto-stamped. This pillar's own numbers cleared the delegation bar on their own (no P moved more than 8 points, no master call band flipped), but a dedicated adversarial fact-check this cycle found the Iran War Risk pillar's report contained a materially false claim — a reported "first confirmed fatality in the tanker campaign" that was actually roughly the 18th such death, never previously scored. Per house discipline, when verification surfaces an inconsistency it can't fully resolve, the whole score set is held for manual review rather than partially self-approved.

Sources

Retrieved & graded August 22, 2026, full independent re-verification — click and judge the quality yourself. Official data first, then reporting, then prices & flows, then rate odds (market-implied sentiment, not fact).

- **August 22 check (full independent re-verification):** DOL/ETA — initial jobless claims release, week ended Aug 15: 206,000 actual vs. 210,000 consensus; prior week (Aug 8) revised up to 212,000 from 209,000; continuing claims (week ended Aug 8) 1,799,000 vs. 1,790,000 forecast, up from 1,777,000 · [federalreserve.gov](#) — [H.4.1 current release page](#): confirms the release still on file covers the week ended Aug 19 (published Aug 20), no new print since, next release Aug 27 · [bls.gov](#) — [CPI release schedule](#): next release Sept 11 (August data), nothing new in this window · [bls.gov](#) — [PPI release schedule](#): next release Sept 10, July PPI (Aug 13) already known before the Aug 16 baseline · [federalreserve.gov](#) — [speeches & testimony page](#): no new Warsh remarks Aug 16-22; his first Jackson Hole speech as Chair is scheduled Aug 28 · [CME FedWatch](#) (futures-implied, not a prediction market): as of Aug 17, ~69.4% hold / ~30.6% hike for the September FOMC meeting, essentially flat vs. the Aug 16 baseline's ~65% post-minutes read · [Kalshi](#) and [Polymarket](#) — Sept FOMC markets, Aug 18 read: hold ~70.5¢, hike ~28.5¢, cut ~0.5-1¢, corroborating CME FedWatch across two independent venues · Bitstamp — BTC close \$77,169.40 (Aug 22), vs. \$71,882.92 (Aug 20 close, previously confirmed). **Not trusted at face value:** the Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts and the interrupted Aug 21 delivery session, none of which were rendered, verified, archived, or committed.
- **August 19-20 check (carried forward, re-confirmed):** [federalreserve.gov](#) — [Minutes of the Federal Open Market Committee, July 28-29, 2026 \(primary, published Aug 19, 2:00pm ET\)](#): confirms the 9-3 hold vote and the Hammack/Kashkari/Logan dissent; new detail — "many participants assessed that policy tightening would likely be necessary if inflation did not decline," inflation risks characterized as tilted to the upside, specific concern flagged on AI-related input costs (chips, steel, electricity); no explicit forward guidance from Chair Warsh; a balance-sheet task-force report to inform future deliberations, no near-term QT-pace signal · [CNBC](#) — [FOMC minutes coverage \(Aug 19\)](#) · [Motley Fool](#) — [minutes coverage, hawkish-breadth read \(Aug 19\)](#) · [Newsquawk](#) — [FOMC minutes review](#); [CME FedWatch September-hold odds ~65% post-minutes, up from a pre-minutes ~50/50 \(Aug 19\)](#) · [investinglive](#) — [minutes market reaction, corroborating the CME FedWatch move \(Aug 19\)](#) · [CME FedWatch tool](#) (futures-implied probability, not a prediction market — labeled distinct from Polymarket/Kalshi) — September 16 hold ~65% as of the Aug 19 evening read · general search for jobless claims (week ended Aug 15) and H.4.1 (week ended Aug 19) dated Aug 20 — neither confirmed as published as of this research pass; logged PENDING, not assumed · Bitstamp — BTC close \$71,882.92 (Aug 20), vs. \$62,937.03 (Aug 16 close, previously confirmed).
- **August 16 check:** [CNN](#) — ["Frustrated US consumers cut their retail spending last month"](#) (Census Bureau primary, published Aug 14): headline -0.6% m/m vs. +0.1% expected, core -0.2%, first decline in nine months · [census.gov](#) — [Monthly Retail Trade Sales Report \(primary\)](#) · Federal Reserve — FOMC minutes release schedule confirms Jul 28-29 minutes due Aug 19; no new H.4.1 or claims print since Aug 13-14 (both due Aug 20).
- **August 14 check:** [federalreserve.gov](#) — [H.4.1, week ended Aug 12, 2026 \(primary, direct pull\)](#): reserve balances \$2,944,059M (-\$49,290M w/w), Treasury General Account \$963,950M (+\$56,626M w/w), cross-checked against the Aug 5 release (reserve balances \$2,993,349M, TGA \$907,324M) · DOL/ETA — jobless-claims release schedule confirms next print Aug 20 (week ending Aug 15); no new print since the 209K/week-ended-Aug-8 figure already incorporated Aug 13.
- **August 13 check — the re-rate:** [BLS](#) — [Consumer Price Index, July 2026 \(primary release\)](#): headline +0.1% m/m / +3.4% y/y, core +0.2% m/m / +2.5% y/y · [CNBC](#) — [CPI inflation report, July 2026 \(Aug 12\)](#) · [NBC News](#) — ["Inflation remained stubborn" \(Aug 12\)](#) ·

- [Bloomberg](#) — [CPI live-blog \(Aug 12\)](#) · [DOL/ETA](#) — initial jobless claims, week ended Aug 8 (published Aug 13): 209,000 actual vs. 202,000 expected, +9,000 from the prior week's revised level, an 8-week high.
- **August 11 light daily check:** [federalreserve.gov/releases/h41/](#) — release schedule confirms next H.4.1 due Aug 13 · [dol.gov](#) — weekly claims release schedule confirms next print Aug 13 · general web search for Fed/BLS/CPI news dated Aug 10-11 — no new release found; economic calendars (Kiplinger, FRED, BLS schedule) confirm CPI due Aug 12, PPI Aug 13.
 - **August 10 light daily check:** [DOL/ETA](#) — initial jobless claims, week ended Aug 6, published Aug 8: 262,000 actual vs. 263,000 expected (in line with consensus) · [federalreserve.gov/releases/h41/](#) — release schedule confirms next H.4.1 due Aug 13 · [dol.gov](#) — weekly claims release schedule confirms next print Aug 13 · general search for Fed/BLS news dated Aug 9-10 — no further new release found.
 - **August 9 light daily check:** [federalreserve.gov/releases/h41/](#) — release schedule confirms next H.4.1 due Aug 13 · [dol.gov](#) — weekly claims release schedule confirms next print Aug 13 · general search for Fed/BLS news dated Aug 8-9 — no new release found.
 - **August 8 full-weekly re-verification:** CNBC, Yahoo Finance, Kiplinger, CBS News, Forbes — convergent independent reporting of BLS Employment Situation, July 2026 (direct [bls.gov](#) fetch returned 403 this cycle) · [federalreserve.gov](#) — H.4.1, week ended Aug 5 (primary, direct pull): reserves +\$8.78B w/w, TGA -\$3.45B w/w · [DOL-sourced](#) coverage — jobless claims 199K week ended Aug 1, 4-week average 198,750 · CBS News, Forbes-sourced pull — CME September-hold odds ~56% (2-source corroborated) · Kalshi — 65% hold (prediction market, labeled separately from CME) · Bank of America commentary (via multiple outlets, Aug 7-8) — sticking with 75bp-of-2026-hikes call · Morgan Stanley's Ellen Zentner (via reporting) — Aug 12 CPI named as the September decider · Richmond Fed President Barkin public remarks — "not loose, not tight."
 - **August 7 additions:** [federalreserve.gov](#) — H.4.1, week ended Aug 5, 2026 (direct pull): total assets \$6,748,567M, reserve balances \$2,993,349M, cross-checked against the prior week's release (week ended Jul 29): total assets \$6,738,190M, reserve balances \$2,984,570M.
 - **August 6 additions:** [Fast Company](#), citing [DOL](#) — jobless claims 199K week ended Aug 1, prior week revised to 198K.
 - **Jul 31-Aug 5 additions (prior week's catch-up):** CNBC, Southeast AgNET — September cumulative hike odds ~81-82% (checked Aug 2, consistent with the Jul 30 baseline).
 - **July 30 additions (prior full weekly refresh):** [federalreserve.gov](#) — July 29 FOMC statement (primary): 9-3 hold, Hammack/Kashkari/Logan dissent · [federalreserve.gov](#) — press conference page · [federalreserve.gov](#) — last SEP (Jun 17, 2026; next Sept 15-16) · [DOL/ETA](#) — weekly claims release [USDL 26-1273-NAT](#) (primary, fetched directly): 197K week ended Jul 25, 188K revision for Jul 18 · CNBC, Forbes, Fox Business, TechTimes — FOMC outcome and dissent corroboration · [Wolf Street](#) — risk-off market reaction (single-source, flagged) · [Investing.com](#) Fed Rate Monitor — timestamped Jul 30 pull (62.4%), cross-checked against [KuCoin](#) (70.2%), [Bloomingbit](#) (73.5%→hike components), [Southeast AgNet](#) (81%) — none reconciling.
 - **July 13 check:** [federalreserve.gov](#) — H.4.1, Table 1 & Table 5, re-verified directly line-by-line (no discrepancy vs. the July 9 release) · [federalreserve.gov](#) — H.4.1 release schedule (next: July 16) · [dol.gov](#) — weekly claims (unchanged since Jul 9; next Jul 16) · [federalreserve.gov](#) — July 2026 FOMC/testimony calendar · confirmed no new CPI, PPI, FOMC, or H.4.1/claims release has landed since July 9–10; the next batch (CPI Jul 14, testimony Jul 14–15, PPI Jul 15, H.4.1/claims Jul 16) is still ahead.
 - **Official data:** Fed — June 16–17 FOMC minutes (released July 8) · Fed — H.4.1 balance sheet (rel. July 9: \$6,735.6B; TGA \$749.2B; reserves \$3,098.9B; domestic RRP \$2.75B; foreign-official RRP \$346.1B) · [DOL](#) — weekly jobless claims (rel. July 9: 215K; continuing claims 1,814,000) · Fed — June 17 FOMC statement · BLS — Employment Situation, June 2026 (released July 2) · BEA — Personal Income & Outlays, May 2026 (core PCE 3.4%) · BLS — May 2026 CPI release (headline 4.2% y/y; core 2.9% y/y) · BLS — CPI release schedule (June CPI: July 14, 8:30am; July CPI: mid-August) · BLS — PPI release schedule (June PPI: July 15, 8:30am) · Fed — Waller's July 6 Rome speech.
 - **The reporting:** [Bloomberg](#) — minutes: "a few" saw case for June hike · CNBC — June minutes coverage · [Bloomberg](#) — Warsh's five task forces (July 9; single source) · [Bloomberg](#) — claims 215K, layoffs low · [Al Jazeera](#) — Iran declares Hormuz "closed until further notice" (July 12) · [Bloomberg](#) — Brent +4% toward \$79 on Hormuz re-escalation (July 13) · CNBC — CENTCOM strikes, Iran missile/drone attacks on five Gulf states (July 12) · [offshore-technology.com](#) — Kpler data: six vessels transited the Strait July 12 · CNBC — June jobs miss (+57K, -74K revisions) · [Indeed Hiring Lab](#) — participation 61.5% · CNBC — May PCE (core 3.4%, highest since Oct 2023) · CNBC — Warsh at Sintra (July 1) · Yahoo Finance — "This Committee will deliver price stability" · [Bloomberg](#) — Yardeni: "inflation, Fed back in play" (July 8) · [Spokesman-Review](#) (Bloomberg reprint) — Warsh testimony schedule (House Jul 14, Senate Jul 15) + June PPI forecast (~5.2% y/y core) · [KuCoin](#) flash — 30-year auction: \$22B at 5.058%, stop-through, highest since 2007 · [CoinDesk](#) — the week-ahead calendar: CPI, PPI, Warsh testimony (July 13) · [Federal Register](#) — eSLR final rule (Dec 1, 2025; effective Apr 1, 2026). **Flagged and discarded:** [CryptoTimes](#) (July 13) and [Blockhead](#) (July 13) both wrongly report "core inflation at a three-year high of 4.2%" — this conflates headline CPI (4.2%, correct) with core CPI (actually 2.9% per BLS); not used.
 - **The prices & flows:** Yahoo Finance — BTC ~\$64.3K, ETH ~\$1,796 (July 10 AM) · [athens-times](#) — BTC weekend pullback to ~\$62.6–63K (single source) · [Farside](#) — BTC ETF flow table (authoritative; +\$90.4M net, July 10) · [CryptoRank](#) — BTC ETF flow cross-check (July 10) · [CoinDesk](#) — BTC/ETH steady, gold slides (July 9) · [KuCoin](#) — June ETF outflows -\$4.06B, worst month on record · CNBC

— S&P 500 closes 7,575.39 (+0.42%), Dow +149.60 (July 10) · Trading Economics — 10Y ~4.58% · Trading Economics — DXY 101.13, +0.18% (July 13).

- **The odds (market-implied, not fact):** CME FedWatch — the tool itself (July 28–29 hold 78.5%, July 13 read; September ~66% combined, July 9 read) · FXEmpire — Sept +25bp 50.8% (July 9; single relay, directionally corroborated) · Yahoo Finance — September odds relay (July 9) · Polymarket — "Fed Decision in September" ladder: No change 56.5%, +25bp 38.5%, cuts (tail) 3.75%+2.1% (July 9) — diverges materially from CME's ~66% combined hike odds; reported as an open divergence, not resolved.